

Task 6

High-Fidelity Prototype & UI/UX Case Study

A step-by-step process guide: from wireframes to a polished, interactive Figma prototype, through simulated usability testing, to a complete case study.

Process Guide | Prepared for project submission

Overview

Task 6 takes the wireframes from earlier stages and turns them into a polished, high-fidelity Figma prototype of 10+ fully designed screens. The screens are connected into an interactive prototype with transitions, overlays, and micro-interactions, then validated through a simulated usability test with three tasks. Feedback from that test drives a round of improvements, and the whole process is documented in a final UI/UX case study.

The process breaks into five stages:

- **1. High-Fidelity Visual Design** — apply the design system to every wireframe screen.
- **2. Interactive Prototyping** — connect screens with links, transitions, overlays, and micro-interactions.
- **3. Simulated Usability Testing** — run 3 representative tasks and record feedback.
- **4. Iteration** — apply improvements based on the usability findings.
- **5. Case Study Write-Up** — document research, design, testing, and the final prototype.

Stage 1 — From Wireframes to High-Fidelity Screens

Every wireframe from the earlier task is rebuilt at high fidelity in Figma, using the established design system rather than placeholder greyscale shapes.

Apply the design system

- **Color:** primary, secondary, and semantic colors (success, warning, error) applied consistently across states.
- **Typography:** a defined type scale (display, heading, body, caption) with consistent weights and line heights.
- **Components:** buttons, inputs, cards, navigation bars, and modals built once as reusable Figma components with variants (default, hover, active, disabled, error).
- **Spacing & grid:** a consistent spacing scale and layout grid so alignment is predictable across screens.
- **Iconography & imagery:** one icon set and a consistent image treatment.

Screen checklist (10+ screens)

- Onboarding / splash screen
- Sign up / log in
- Home / dashboard
- Search or browse view
- List or feed view
- Detail view
- Form or input flow (e.g. checkout, booking, creation)
- Confirmation / success state

- Profile or settings
- Empty, loading, and error states

Each screen should be built as its own Figma frame at a consistent device size, using auto layout so components resize predictably.

Stage 2 — Building the Interactive Prototype

With the screens designed, Figma's prototyping mode connects them into a clickable flow that behaves like the real product.

- **Prototype links:** wire buttons, cards, and navigation items to the correct destination frames.
- **Animations:** use Smart Animate for transitions between similar frames (e.g. list to detail) so elements move rather than jump-cut.
- **Overlays:** use overlay connections for modals, menus, tooltips, and toasts, with a defined close behavior.
- **Micro-interactions:** button press states, toggle switches, form validation feedback, and loading indicators.
- **Navigation model:** a persistent structure (tab bar, nav drawer, or top nav) wired identically across every screen.

The result is a single starting frame that a tester can open in Presentation mode and click through without any explanation of what to do next.

Stage 3 — Simulated Usability Testing

Before finalizing the design, the prototype is tested against three representative tasks. Each task is run with a small set of testers (or simulated personas), and feedback is captured in a consistent format.

Task	What it tests	What to record
Task 1 — Core flow (e.g. complete a purchase / sign-up)	Whether the primary path is discoverable and efficient	Successful, time on task, points of hesitation
Task 2 — Secondary flow (e.g. search or filter for an item)	Whether navigation and information architecture is clear	Misclicks, wrong clicks, wrong returns, confusing labels
Task 3 — Recovery flow (e.g. edit info or fix an error)	Whether error states and edits are understood	Clarity of feedback, ease of correction

Feedback log format

- Tester ID / persona, task attempted, outcome (success, partial, fail)
- Observed behavior and direct quotes
- Severity of any issue (minor, moderate, critical)
- Screen or component where the issue occurred

Stage 4 — Iterating on Feedback

Findings from the usability test are grouped by severity and addressed directly in the Figma file, keeping a record of what changed and why.

- **Critical issues** (blocked task completion) are fixed first — e.g. a missing link, an unclear primary action.
- **Moderate issues** (caused hesitation or confusion) are addressed next — e.g. ambiguous labels, low-contrast text.
- **Minor issues** (cosmetic or low-impact) are logged and fixed if time allows.
- Each fix is documented as: issue → change made → expected impact.

Stage 5 — The UI/UX Case Study

The final deliverable is a case study that tells the story of the project end to end, built to sit in a portfolio.

Suggested structure

- **1. Overview** — the problem, the users, the goal of the project.
- **2. Research** — key insights that shaped the design (user needs, pain points, competitive scan).
- **3. Wireframes** — low-fidelity structure and the reasoning behind key layout decisions.
- **4. Visual design** — the design system (color, type, components) and final high-fidelity screens.
- **5. Prototype** — how the screens connect; a link to the interactive Figma prototype.
- **6. Usability testing** — the 3 tasks, what was found, and the severity of each issue.
- **7. Iteration** — before/after comparisons showing what changed in response to feedback.
- **8. Reflection** — what worked, what you'd do differently, and next steps.

Final Submission Checklist

- ■ 10+ high-fidelity screens, built from the design system
- ■ All screens connected with prototype links
- ■ Smart Animate transitions on key flows
- ■ Overlays used for modals, menus, or tooltips
- ■ At least one micro-interaction (button state, toggle, validation)
- ■ Usability test run on 3 tasks, with recorded feedback
- ■ Design improvements made in response to feedback
- ■ Case study document covering research through final prototype
- ■ Shareable link to the interactive Figma prototype included in the submission

This guide outlines the process only — the Figma file itself (screens, prototype links, and usability notes) is built directly in Figma and linked in your submission.